

## The basic principle of Counting

Suppose that there are two experiments are to be performed.

If ① experiment 1 can result in any one of ' $m$ ' possible outcomes and

② for each outcome of experiment 1 there are ' $n$ ' possible outcomes of experiment 2

then together there are ' $mn$ ' possible outcomes of the two

experiments.

Eg: II

A small community consists of

10 women, each of whom has 3 children.

If one woman and one of her children

are to be chosen as a mother

and child of the year,

then how many different choices

are possible?

Experiment 1

(choosing a mother)

$w_1$

$w_2$

$w_3$

$\vdots$

$w_{10}$



3 children



3 children.

In experiment 1, selecting a women has 10 possible choices (outcomes) and for each women there are three choices in experiment 2.  
The total number of possible choices are

$$10 \times 3 = \underline{\underline{30}}$$

For more than two experiments, the basic principle of counting can be generalized.



- Let  $r$  experiments are performed.

The first one may result in  $n_1$  possible outcomes; and if, for each of these  $n_1$  outcomes there are  $n_2$  possible outcomes of the second experiment and if for each of the possible outcome of the first two experiments, there are  $n_3$  possible outcomes of the third experiment and if, ... (Continuous)

then there are  $n_1 \cdot n_2 \cdot n_3 \cdots n_r$  possible outcomes of the  $r$  experiments.

Eg: [1]: A college planning Committee consists of 3 freshmen, 4 sophomores, 5 juniors and 2 seniors. A Subcommittee of 4, consisting of 1 person from each class is to be chosen. How many different subcommittees are possible?

Sol<sup>n</sup>:

The choice of Subcommittee can be seen as a combined outcome of four different experiment of choosing single representative from each class.

From the basic principle of Counting



there are

$$3 \times 4 \times 5 \times 2 = 120$$

possible sub committees.

Eg 2: How many different 5-place license plates are possible if first two places are to be occupied by letters and final three places by numbers?

Sol<sup>n</sup>: There are 26 letters, for first place there are 26 possible outcomes and for each one of them there are 26 possible outcomes in second place.

For each choice of first two places  
there are 10 choices.

similarly, for fourth and fifth place

From basic principle of Counting

there are

$$26 \times 26 \times 10 \times 10 \times 10$$

$$= 676,000.$$

number of possible license plates.

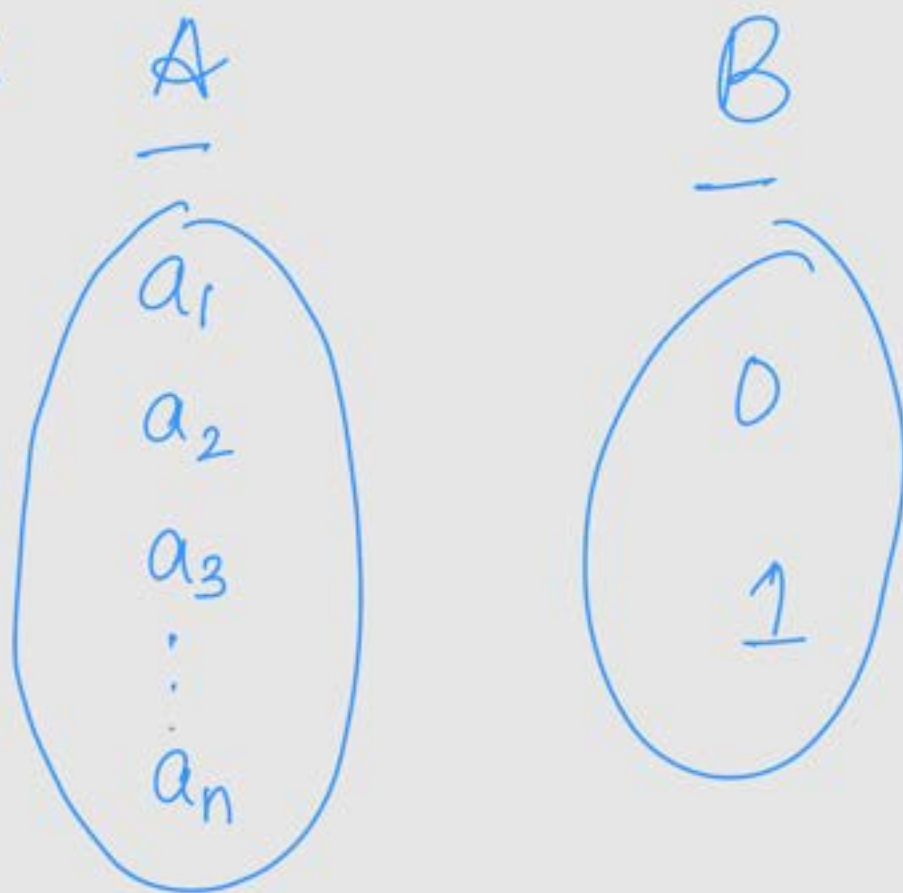
Eg 3: Let  $A = \{a_1, a_2, a_3, \dots, a_n\}$

and  $B = \{0, 1\}$ . How many

different functions be defined from

set A to set B?

Sol<sup>n</sup> :



A function  $f : A \rightarrow B$  will

map  $a_1$  to either 0 (or) 1

For  $f(a_1)$  there are two choices  
0 (or) 1

$f(a_2)$  has two choices 0 (or) 1

$\vdots$

$f(a_n)$  has two choices 0 (or) 1



Therefore, there are

$$2 \times 2 \times 2 \times \dots \times 2 \text{ (n times)} \\ = 2^n$$

possible functions from  $A$  to  $B$ .

- In general for any two finite sets  $A$  and  $B$ , there are

$|B|^{|A|}$  number of distinct functions can be defined.

Hence  $|A|$  = no. of elements in  $A$

$|B|$  = no. of elements in  $B$ .

# Permutations

Suppose there are ' $n$ ' objects.

Each ordered arrangement of ' $n$ ' objects is called a "Permutation".

The first object in the permutation can be any one of the ' $n$ ' objects.

The second object in the permutation can be chosen from any of the remaining  $(n-1)$  objects and so on...

From basic counting principle there are

$$n \cdot (n-1) (n-2) (n-3) \dots 3 \cdot 2 \cdot 1 \\ = n!$$

different permutations of the 'n' objects

Eg [1]: How many batting orders are possible for a cricket team consisting of 11 players?

Sol<sup>n</sup>: Each batting order refers to a permutation of 11 objects. There are  $11!$  possible batting orders.

Eg [2]: How many different letter arrangements can be



formed from the letters PEPPER?

Sol<sup>n</sup>:- If all p's and E's

are distinguished from one another then there are

$$6! = 720.$$

However there are three p's and two E's, so their permutations result in the same arrangement.

Therefore there are

$$\frac{6!}{3! 2!} = 60$$

different letter arrangements  
formed.

## Combinations

We are often interested in  
determining the number of  
distinct groups of  $r$  objects  
that could be formed from a  
total number of  $n$  objects.

For example: There are 5  
objects  $A, B, C, D, E$

To know the number of distinct groups of 3 formed from these 5 items:

There are 5 ways of selecting the first item, 4 ways to select next item and 3 ways to select the final item. That is there are  $5 \times 4 \times 3$  when the order in which they are arranged is relevant.

However, for choosing a group of three items (their) order



is irrelevant and each group items arranged  $3!$  way.

The total number of groups of 3 items formed from 5 items is,

$$\frac{5 \times 4 \times 3}{3 \times 2 \times 1} = 10.$$

In general, the number of distinct groups of  $r$  objects formed from ' $n$ ' objects

is,

$$\begin{aligned} & \frac{n(n-1)(n-2) \cdots (n-r+1)}{r!} \\ &= \frac{n(n-1)(n-2) \cdots (n-r+1)(n-r)!}{r! (n-r)!} \\ &= \frac{n!}{(n-r)! r!} \end{aligned}$$

For  $r \leq n$ , the notation used is,

$$\binom{n}{r} = \frac{n!}{(n-r)! r!}$$

Eg II : A Committee of 3

is to be formed from a group of 20 people. How many different Committees are possible?

Sol<sup>n</sup>:-

There are  $\binom{20}{3}$

$$= \frac{20!}{17! \cdot 3!}$$

$$= 1140$$

possible Committees.



Eg [2]: From a group of 5 women

and 7 men, how many different

Committees consisting of 2 women

and 3 men can be formed?

What if 2 men feeding and

refuse to serve the Committee together?

Sol<sup>n</sup>:- There are  $\binom{5}{2}$  possible

groups of 2 women and

$\binom{7}{3}$  possible groups of 3 men.

From basic counting principle,

$$\text{there are } \binom{5}{2} \cdot \binom{7}{3} = 350$$

possible committees consisting of  
2 women and 3 men.

Now suppose 2 of the men  
refuse to serve together.

Note that there are

$$\binom{2}{2} \binom{5}{1} = 5 \text{ groups}$$

of 3 men contains both of  
the feuding men out of

$$\binom{7}{3} = 35 \text{ groups of 3 men.}$$

So, there are  $35 - 5 = 30$

groups of 3 men that do not

conting both of the feuding

men.

This follows that

$$\begin{aligned} 30 \times \binom{5}{2} &= 30 \times 10 \\ &= 300 \end{aligned}$$

possible committees (such that

both feuding men are not together).



# Multinomial Coefficients

In this section we consider the following problem:

"A set of  $n$  distinct items is to be divided into  $r$  distinct groups of respective sizes  $n_1, n_2, n_3, \dots, n_r$  where  $\sum_{i=1}^r n_i = n$ .

How many different divisions are possible?"

- To answer this, firstly note that there are  $\binom{n}{n_1}$  possible

choices for group of size  $n_1$ .

- After forming first group of size  $n_1$ , there are  $(n-n_1)$  items remaining.

- For each choice of first group, there are  $\binom{n-n_1}{n_2}$  possible choices for the second group.

and so on . . . .

Applying basic counting principle

there are

$$\begin{aligned}
& \binom{n}{n_1} \binom{n-n_1}{n_2} \cdots \binom{n-n_1-n_2-\cdots-n_{r-1}}{n_r} \\
&= \frac{n!}{(n-n_1)! n_1!} \frac{(n-n_1)!}{(n-n_1-n_2)! n_2!} \cdots \frac{(n-n_1-n_2-\cdots-n_{r-1})!}{0! n_r!} \\
&= \frac{n!}{n_1! n_2! n_3! \cdots n_r!}
\end{aligned}$$

possible divisions.

If  $n_1 + n_2 + n_3 + \cdots + n_r = n$ , we

define  $\binom{n}{n_1 n_2 n_3 \cdots n_r}$  by

$$\binom{n}{n_1 n_2 n_3 \cdots n_r} = \frac{n!}{n_1! n_2! \cdots n_r!}$$



Thus  $\binom{n}{n_1, n_2, n_3, \dots, n_r}$  represents the number of possible divisions of  $n$  distinct objects into  $r$  distinct groups of respective sizes  $n_1, n_2, \dots, n_r$ .

Eg 1: A police department in a small city consists of 15 officers. If the department policy is to have 10 of the officers patrolling the streets, 2 of the officers working full time at the station and 3 of the officers reserve

at the station. In how many ways these officers be deployed?

Sol<sup>n</sup>: The number ways these 15 officers deployed is same as the number possible divisions of 15 into 3 distinct groups of size 10, 2, 3 respectively

$$\begin{aligned} \text{The answer is, } & \binom{15}{10 \ 2 \ 3} \\ &= \frac{15!}{10! \ 2! \ 3!} \end{aligned}$$

$\Rightarrow 30,030$  possible divisions.

Eg [2]: Ten children are to be divided into A team and a B team of 5 each. How many divisions are possible?

Sol<sup>n</sup>: There are  $\frac{10!}{5!5!}$   
 $\Rightarrow 252$  possible division.



Problem: The number of integer solutions of Equations.

An individual has gone to the fishing lake that contains  $x$  types of fishes namely type 1, type 2, type 3 . . . type  $x$ .

If we take the result of the fishing trip to be the number of each type of the fish caught.

Let  $x_i$  denote the number of type  $i$  fish caught. and a total of  $n$  fishes were caught then

$$x_1 + x_2 + x_3 + \dots + x_r = n.$$

Thus number of possible outcomes when a total of  $n$  fishes were caught is same as the number of non-negative integer valued  $(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_r)$  s.t

$$x_1 + x_2 + \dots + x_r = n \quad \text{--- (1)}$$

First we compute the number of positive integer valued vectors  $(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_r)$  satisfy equation (1).

Suppose there are  $n$  fishes lined up there are  $(n-1)$  spaces b/w them. We wish to divide them into  $r$  distinct groups.

Equivalently, we need to choose  $(r-1)$  spaces from  $(n-1)$  spaces



The number of positive integer solution of (1) is

$$\binom{n-1}{r-1}$$

- Now we obtain the number of non-neg. integer solution of  $x_1 + x_2 + x_3 + \dots + x_r = n$ .

It is same as the number of positive solutions of equation  $y_1 + y_2 + \dots + y_r = n + r$ .

$$(y_i = x_i + 1)$$

Thus,

there are  $\binom{n+r-1}{r-1}$  number  
of non-negative integer solutions  
of equation

$$x_1 + x_2 + x_3 + \dots + x_r = n$$

Ex [3]  $\therefore$  How many distinct  
non-negative integer-valued  
solutions of  $x_1 + x_2 = 3$  are  
possible?

Sol<sup>n</sup>  $\therefore$   $n = 3$ ,  $r = 2$

$$\binom{n+r-1}{r-1} = \binom{3+2-1}{2-1} = 4$$

